

Skills

Obtaining a Specimen from an Indwelling Urinary Catheter

Checklist

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S = Satisfactory U = Unsatisfactory NP = Not Performed

Step	S	U	NP	Comments
Checked the specimen container labels and, when necessary, completed the lab requisition.	☐	☐	☐	
Verified the health care provider's orders for the type of urinary specimen test.	☐	☐	☐	
Gathered the necessary equipment and supplies and provided for patient privacy.	☐	☐	☐	
Performed hand hygiene and donned gloves. Donned additional PPE based on the patient's need for isolation precautions or the risk of exposure to bodily fluids.	☐	☐	☐	
Introduced self to the patient and family.	☐	☐	☐	
Identified the patient using two identifiers. Compared the identifiers to the patient's records.	☐	☐	☐	
Explained the procedure to the patient and ensured that he or she agreed to the treatment.	☐	☐	☐	
Collected urine from an indwelling urinary catheter:	☐	☐	☐	
1. Explained that a syringe would be used to remove the urine through the catheter port. Reassured the patient that he or she would experience no discomfort.				
2. Explained why the specimen could not be obtained from the drainage bag. Explained that the catheter would need to be clamped for 10 to 15 minutes before obtaining a urine specimen.				
3. Used a clamp or rubber band to clamp the drainage tubing below the urine sampling port for 10 to 15 minutes.				
4. Returned to the patient's room after 10 to 15 minutes. Performed hand hygiene and applied clean gloves.				
5. Located the port where the catheter attached to the drainage bag tube. Cleaned the port with an antiseptic solution per organization's practice. Allowed antiseptic to dry.				
6. Attached an appropriately sized needleless syringe, blunt plastic valve, or slip-tip syringe to the catheter specimen sampling port, using aseptic technique.				
7. Withdrew urine into the syringe. Obtained the required amount of urine for the ordered laboratory test.				

8. Transferred the urine in the syringe into an appropriate container. Transferred the urine from the syringe into a clean urine container for routine studies or into a sterile container if a culture was ordered.
9. Placed the lid tightly onto the container. In the presence of the patient, labeled the specimen per the organization's practice. Securely attached the label to the urine specimen container, not the lid. Prepared the specimen for the lab per agency policy.
10. Unclamped the catheter, and allowed the urine to flow into the drainage bag. Ensured that the urine flowed freely.

Disposed of used supplies and equipment. ☐ ☐ ☐

Prepared the specimen for transport. Immediately transported the specimen to the laboratory. If specimen transport was delayed, followed the organization's practice for storage. ☐ ☐ ☐

1. Placed the labeled specimen in a biohazard bag.
2. If the specimen required ice for transport, placed the specimen in a biohazard bag then placed the bag with the specimen into a second biohazard bag filled with ice slurry.

Helped the patient into a comfortable position, and placed toiletries and personal items within reach. ☐ ☐ ☐

Placed the call light within easy reach, and made sure the patient knew how to use it to summon assistance. ☐ ☐ ☐

Raised the appropriate number of side rails, and lowered the bed to the lowest position. ☐ ☐ ☐

Removed and disposed of gloves. Performed hand hygiene. ☐ ☐ ☐

Documented the procedure in the patient's record. ☐ ☐ ☐

Learner: _____
Evaluator: _____
Date: _____

Signature: _____
Signature: _____